

# Business-Owner Planning Checklist

A self-guided checklist for business owners balancing business and personal financial decisions.

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For many business owners, the business itself represents a significant share of personal net worth — which means business decisions and personal financial planning are more connected than they might first appear. This checklist is designed to help you think through where the two intersect, from retirement plan design to eventual succession. It's a starting point for reflection, not a substitute for an individualized conversation.

## Business & Personal Finances

Have you separated your personal financial plan from your business's financial plan, or are they still intertwined?

Have you reviewed what percentage of your net worth is tied up in your business?

Have you set aside personal savings outside of the business?

Have you coordinated with a tax professional on business structure and tax considerations?

## Retirement Plan Design

Have you evaluated retirement plan options (SEP IRA, SIMPLE IRA, 401(k), and similar) for yourself and your employees?

Have you reviewed whether your current plan design still fits your business and workforce?

## Succession & Risk

Have you thought about a succession or exit plan, even if a transition isn't imminent?

Have you considered how a sale or transition would affect your personal financial goals?

Have you reviewed buy-sell agreements, if you have business partners?

Have you reviewed your business's insurance coverage (liability, key-person, disability) recently?

Have you documented a plan for what happens to the business if something unexpected happens to you?

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**Next step: if several of these items raise questions for you, an introductory conversation may help.  
Reach out any time — there's no cost or obligation to talk.**

This checklist is educational and informational only. It is not individualized investment, tax, or legal advice, is not a complete financial plan, and should not be relied on as the sole basis for any financial decision. Items on this checklist may not apply to every situation. [COMPLIANCE REVIEW REQUIRED]

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